

Here of course we might render "in immortality"; but in *Ys* 48¹ we read:

That which was long since foretold shall be dealt out in eternity to demons and to men.

Amərətūt is capable therefore of meaning simply endless existence. The phrase *yavōi vīspāi*, "to all time," is unmistakable in *Ys* 46¹¹, where it is said of the Karapans and Kavis (pp. 140, 157):

Their own soul and their own Self shall torment them when they come to the Bridge of the Separater. To all time will they be guests for the House of the Lie.

The same phrase is used of the happiness of the righteous. In the light of these two expressions we can hardly doubt that *darəga*, "long," means "eternal" in this connexion. In *Ys* 30¹¹ "long punishment," and 31²⁰ "the future long age of misery, of darkness, ill food, and crying of woe," are as clearly endless as in 33⁵ is the "long life" of him who treads "the straight ways unto Right, wherein Mazdah Ahura dwells." *Utayūiti*, "perpetuity," is another word used of both states: see *Ys* 45⁷, just quoted, and 33⁸.

The future of the righteous and of the wicked is accordingly marked out clearly enough, and the contrast is as that of noon and midnight. So reasonable and practical a thinker was not likely to overlook the fact that a large proportion of men will not easily fall into classes between which there is a great gulf fixed. Since provision was admittedly made for this in later Parsism, the presumption is in favour of the expectation that Zarathushtra would not omit to deal with it. And there are two Gathic passages where the recognition of the Limbo doctrine